



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Westminster Academy
School Website: <https://www.wamemphis.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Westminster Academy TN 38119 currently presents no publicly accessible evidence of classical education practices in its crawl content. The school's public-facing site (as retrieved in the crawl) shows a Maintenance page with no educational content to indicate a classical framework (evidence: a maintenance notice from the crawl for the site [wamemphis.com](https://www.wamemphis.com/)). Because the available public materials do not reveal the core elements of classical education (e.g., Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, scholé, liturgy, great conversation, or explicit formation of virtue), the evaluation across all six categories falls into NOT CLASSICAL.

Notes on the rubric and keyword framework used:

- The Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) provide explicit positive/negative keyword indicators across six domains (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents & Community). These indicators include terms such as truth, beauty, virtue, theology, Great Books, Socratic discussion, scholé, chant, liturgy, and partnerships with families, among others.
- The Positive Keyword Lexicon used to ground the analysis emphasizes terms like truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, formation, great books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic dialogue, scholé, liturgy, and related articulations of a classical humanities framework.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **NOT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The public materials retrieved from Westminster Academy's crawl are effectively a Maintenance page with no content on transcendental truth, virtue, theology, liturgy, or communal sacred practices. This provides no textual support for transcendental moral realism, liturgical practices, or theological grounding.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present keywords: none (no textual content to match positive indicators such as truth, virtue, theology, liturgy, or wonder; nor negative indicators).
- Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords = 0, Negative keywords = 0 (0% for both; no textual evidence to evaluate against the lists).
- Reference framework: Positive/Negative keyword indicators are drawn from the Six Essential Elements corpus (e.g., the presence of truth, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, etc.). See the listed indicators for Element 1.

- Why this rating
- Without explicit textual references to transcendent moral realism, theology, liturgical practice, or sacred community rhythms in publicly accessible materials, the category cannot be rated Classical. The absence of evidence yields NOT CLASSICAL for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- No public content indicates formation of virtue or wisdom as telos, nor a claim that truth/goodness/beauty are real or that education is formation rather than information (as per the classical rubric). The accessible crawl content is silent on these aims.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present keywords: none (no formation- or virtue-centered language detected in the crawl content).
- Quantitative estimate: Positive = 0, Negative = 0 (0% vs 0% due to absence).
- Framework reference: See the Six Essential Elements category 2 indicators for positive terms like formation, virtue, wisdom, and the telos of true/good/beautiful. These are described in the document set.
- Why this rating
- The absence of stated formation goals, pursuit of transcendental aims, or a stated telos in public materials places this category outside Classical alignment.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The crawl content for Westminster Academy does not reveal curriculum specifics (e.g., Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, or Great Conversation). No explicit curricular elements are visible in the public material, beyond the Maintenance page.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present keywords: none (no mention of Great Books, history as Western civilization, liberal arts, Latin/Greek, or related curricular anchors).
- Quantitative estimate: Positive = 0, Negative = 0 (0% matches due to lack of content).
- Framework reference: The Six Essentials' Curriculum indicators include Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, and Wonder, among others. See the positive cues (e.g., Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books) in the document.
- Why this rating
- Without textual evidence of Classics-based curriculum, Great Books participation, or liberal-arts structuring in public materials, the curriculum category does not align with Classical aims.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The current site crawl yields no pedagogy-specific language (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé, chanting, memory work, or upper-level rhetoric training). The visible content is effectively a maintenance notice.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present keywords: none.

- Quantitative estimate: Positive = 0, Negative = 0.
- Framework reference: Pedagogical indicators include Socratic dialogue, chanting, scholé, and rhetoric training as per the Six Essentials.
- Why this rating
- Absence of documented or publicly stated classical pedagogy indicators results in NOT CLASSICAL for this category.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The crawl content provides no details about faculty as models, living curriculum, or mentor culture (the site is down to a maintenance page).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present keywords: none.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive = 0, Negative = 0.
- Framework reference: The Six Essentials lists features like “model teachers and mentors,” “living curriculum,” and “faculty as the core” in its Faculty indicators.
- Why this rating
- No publicly accessible evidence of faculty characteristics aligned with Classical ideals; therefore NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- There is no accessible public material from the Westminster Academy crawl indicating partnership with parents, parent formation activities, or open-campus visitation. The visible page is a Maintenance notice.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present keywords: none.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive = 0, Negative = 0.
- Framework reference: The Six Essentials lists “Partnership with Families,” “parent formation,” and “open campus/visitor access” as key indicators.
- Why this rating
- In the absence of public content demonstrating parent partnership and community engagement, this category does not align with Classical models.

Aggregate Ranking

- Overall classification: NOT CLASSICAL
- Rationale: Across all six categories, public crawl content reveals no explicit or implicit classical signals (e.g., Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, scholé, liturgical practices, virtuous formation, or active parent/community partnerships). The Westminster Academy site currently presents maintenance content with no evaluative material to support a Classical orientation. This aligns with NOT CLASSICAL under the Classical School rubric. The foundational keyword indicators provided by the Six Essential Elements and the supporting lexicon document emphasize that genuine Classical alignment relies

on explicit textual signals; those signals are absent in the retrieved public materials for Westminster Academy.

What Would Move the Needle

- Note: Not applicable to move a NOT CLASSICAL school into SOMEWHAT or CLASSICAL based on current public materials. If Westminster Academy chooses to pursue a classical-revival trajectory, the following concrete steps would be needed (in line with the Six Essential Elements and its keyword framework):
- Publish a public, explicit statement of purpose or telos that emphasizes formation, virtue, and a transcendent understanding of truth, goodness, and beauty (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations).
- Adopt a clearly defined classical curriculum framework (Seven Liberal Arts with Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books; history as Western civilization; study of primary texts) and embed these terms on the website and in brochures (Curriculum).
- Implement a pedagogy that includes Socratic discussion, memorization/recitation rooted in traditional magisterial texts, and contemplative learning (Scholé) in lower grades and rhetoric/seminar work in upper grades (Pedagogy).
- Elevate faculty as living exemplars of virtue and mentorship; present a clear portrait of the teacher-student relationship as the living curriculum (Faculty).
- Establish and communicate a robust partnership with parents; provide parent-formation opportunities (book clubs, lectures) and open campus visitation policies (Parents & Community).

These needle-moving steps would require a deliberate rebranding and implementation plan, plus transparent public-facing materials consistent with classical criteria. See the Indicative Lists of Positive Keywords for guidance.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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